

Deliberation Report

Final Report

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Climate and Innovation Act

A) Problem statement and context

Switzerland imports around three quarters of its energy, and all mineral oil and natural gas consumed in the country comes from abroad. This creates two linked problems: high dependence on foreign energy supplies and significant climate emissions from fossil fuels. The Climate and Innovation Act is designed to address both by gradually reducing mineral oil and natural gas consumption, supporting heating replacements, and funding climate-friendly innovation. Its goal is for Switzerland to become climate neutral by 2050.

The bill is an indirect counter-proposal to the Glacier Initiative. Unlike a fossil-fuel ban, it aims for a gradual transition through incentives and support measures. A referendum has been called, so the key question is whether Swiss people should adopt the Act.

Across the deliberation groups, the dominant pattern was **conditional support**. Participants generally favored the Act's climate and energy-security goals, but only if implementation is practical, funding is credible, and households, tenants, workers, municipalities, and small businesses are protected from unfair cost burdens.

B) The assembly's recommended policy

Recommended policy: Yes with implementation safeguards

More specifically, the assembly's preferred direction is to **adopt the Act, but only with strong safeguards for affordability, administrative simplicity, and predictable funding**.

The best-fitting composite recommendation is:

- adopt the Climate and Innovation Act,
- keep procedures simple and low-bureaucracy,
- ensure reliable funding and clear timelines,
- protect vulnerable households and tenants,
- avoid hidden cost shifting to small businesses or industry,
- and implement the law in a way that is practical for cantons, communes, and affected sectors.

This recommendation combines the main strengths of the Act with the conditions most consistently requested across participants.

C) 6 key reasons supporting the recommendation

1. **It reduces fossil-fuel dependence**

Switzerland imports most of its energy, so lowering oil and gas consumption improves resilience and reduces exposure to foreign supply shocks.

2. **It advances climate protection without a hard ban**

The law is seen as a pragmatic step toward climate neutrality by 2050, while avoiding an abrupt prohibition that could face stronger resistance.

3. **It supports innovation and future-oriented jobs**

Funding climate-friendly technologies and heating transitions can strengthen Swiss innovation, create work for trades, and support modernization.

4. **It improves planning security**

A gradual transition is easier for households, firms, utilities, and public authorities to plan around than sudden regulatory change.

5. **It can be made socially fair**

Many participants supported the Act when it includes protections for renters, low-income households, pensioners, students, and vulnerable groups.

6. **It is more acceptable than the status quo**

Most participants rejected doing nothing. They saw the law as a practical compromise between climate responsibility, affordability, and feasibility.

D) 6 key reasons against or risks identified

1. **Risk of bureaucracy**

A repeated concern was that the law could become too complex, with excessive forms, reporting, and administrative burden.

2. **Risk of hidden costs**

Participants worried costs might be passed on to tenants, households, electricity users, SMEs, exporters, or municipalities.

3. **Implementation capacity may be uneven**

Cantons and communes may not all have the same staffing, expertise, or delivery capacity, making rollout uneven.

4. **Public spending could become too open-ended**

Some participants feared unlimited or poorly capped spending could undermine fiscal prudence and public trust.

5. **Too many exceptions could weaken the law**

Sector-specific carve-outs, especially if broad, could reduce coherence and climate impact.

6. **Climate ambition may still be too slow for some**

A smaller but important minority felt the Act is too gradual and does not move fast enough toward stronger climate action.

E) Implementation considerations and conditions

To maintain broad support, the Act should be implemented with the following conditions:

1. Simplify application and reporting procedures

Keep forms short, clarify responsibilities between federal and cantonal levels, and minimize paperwork.

2. Protect vulnerable households automatically where possible

Renters, low-income households, pensioners, students, and people with disabilities should have easy access to aid without complicated applications.

3. Use predictable and credible funding

The law should come with reliable financing so support for heating replacements and innovation is actually deliverable.

4. Prevent cost shifting

Ensure renovation support does not simply become higher rent, higher electricity bills, or competitive disadvantage for firms.

5. Set clear milestones and rollout timelines

Participants valued predictability. Milestones help cantons, communes, utilities, and businesses plan investment and staffing.

6. Target support where it has the highest effect

Prioritize heating replacement, local energy security, and climate-friendly innovation rather than diffuse or weak programs.

7. Keep flexibility for difficult sectors

Agriculture and some rural or energy-intensive sectors may need tailored rules, but exemptions should remain limited and justified.

8. Monitor implementation closely

Regular review should check administrative burden, cost distribution, and whether support reaches the intended groups.

F) Initial and final positions of each participant with scores 1–5

Participant | Initial score | Final score | Initial position | Final position |

|—|—:|—:|—|—|

Lina Meier | 4 | 4 | Supportive if it keeps housing and energy affordable for workers. | Stronger support for households / safeguards for affordability and fairness. |

Markus Huber | 2 | 2 | Skeptical, though open if support is simple and costs stay low. | Remains skeptical; wants simplified implementation and low bureaucracy. |

Sabine Keller | 5 | 5 | Strongly supportive as a practical bridge to climate neutrality. | Strong support, especially with guaranteed funding and implementation discipline. |

René Baumann | 1 | 1 | Mostly against, fearing higher costs and less freedom for households. | Remains opposed; prefers status quo or rejection due to cost and bureaucracy concerns. |

Nadia Aksoy | 5 | 5 | Very supportive, but wants even faster action than this law. | Strong support, especially with household and tenant protections. |

Tobias Schmid | 3 | 4 | Leaning yes if jobs improve and living costs stay manageable. | More supportive after weighing practicality and implementation safeguards. |

Eliane Rossi | 4 | 4 | Somewhat supportive if it protects health and pensioner budgets. | Support remains conditional on fairness, affordability, and simplicity. |

Peter Frei | 3 | 4 | Conditionally supportive if industry gets predictable rules and aid. | More supportive with practical safeguards and cost control. |

Maya Yilmaz | 4 | 4 | Supportive only if tenants are protected from renovation costs. | Support remains strong with tenant and affordability protections. |

Daniel Zemp | 4 | 4 | Supportive if it guarantees retraining and no layoffs. | Support remains strong with household and worker protection. |

Franziska Widmer | 4 | 4 | Generally supportive, but wants clearer grid and investment timelines. | Support remains strong with emphasis on reliability and planning. |

Silvan Brunner | 3 | 4 | Cautiously supportive if farming costs and rules stay manageable. | More supportive, especially with sector-specific flexibility. |

Amina Cherif | 4 | 4 | Supportive if the act includes accessible help for vulnerable households. | Strong support with a focus on accessibility and inclusion. |

Thomas Cavadini | 3 | 4 | Mixed: likes the goals, worries implementation will strain cantons. | More supportive if implementation is simplified and clearly defined. |

Giulia Moretti | 3 | 4 | Conditionally supportive if financing and rent impacts are controlled. | More supportive with stronger implementation safeguards. |

Hans-Ruedi Suter | 4 | 4 | Mostly supportive because it creates work for trades and lowers emissions. | Strong support for practical, low-bureaucracy implementation. |

Noémie Favre | 4 | 4 | Supportive if renters and students are protected from higher bills. | Strong support with affordability and tenant protection. |

Klaus Gerber | 2 | 2 | Skeptical unless heavy industry gets strong cost protection. | Remains skeptical without stronger competitiveness safeguards. |

Rita Bianchi | 2 | 3 | Uncertain, mainly worried about bills and paperwork. | More open to a moderate yes if bureaucracy is limited. |

Florian Jost | 4 | 4 | Supportive if municipalities get funding and clear mandates. | Strong support with low-bureaucracy, practical implementation. |

Overall takeaway

The deliberation did **not** produce an unconditional endorsement. Instead, it converged on a **qualified yes**: adopt the Climate and Innovation Act, but only with strong safeguards that make it affordable, simple, fair, and feasible in practice.

If you want, I can also turn this into a **shorter executive summary** or a **formal report format with headings and numbering suitable for submission**.

Assembly Composition

- **Participants:** 20

- **Gender:** female: 10, male: 10
- **Education:** apprenticeship/technical school: 8, BA/MA university: 9, no formal education: 1, primary school: 2
- **Settlement:** rural: 5, urban: 15

Process Analytics

- **Total turns:** 60
- **Total words:** 4463
- **Avg words/turn:** 74
- **Gini coefficient (equity):** 0.06 (0 = perfectly equal, 1 = one person dominated)
- **Most active:** Amina Cherif
- **Least active:** Lina Meier

Design Integrity

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        "Energy-poor households and social assistance recipients",
        "Large fossil-fuel dependent sectors (oil heating installers, gas supply, fuel retailers)",
        "Consumer protection groups focused on price pass-through",
        "Homeowners in detached/rural housing with high retrofit costs",
        "Building industry actors (insulation, construction, real estate finance)",
        "Public health professionals",
        "Environmental justice representatives from immigrant/minority communities",
        "Youth climate activists outside university/urban circles",
        "Small municipalities/cantons with limited administrative capacity",
        "Electricity/network operators at transmission level",
        "Opponents concerned with tax burden and state intervention in a more explicit way"
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      "Add explicit opposition personas and arguments: cost-conscious taxpayers, fossil-fuel-dependent l
      "Add energy poverty and social-equity voices: welfare recipients, low-income families with poor h
      "Add sectoral voices from construction, insulation, heating replacement, grid operators, and fuel
      "Include public health and environmental justice perspectives to balance climate/innovation fram
```

```

    "Broaden geographic representation with very small municipalities and cantonal implementation strategies"
    "Reduce overconcentration of urban/policy-professional personas and increase representation of less urban areas"
    "Revise the issue brief to present symmetrical trade-offs: emissions reductions, costs, enforcement measures"
    "Use a structured adversarial prompt set so each group must articulate the strongest objection to the proposal"
    "Document how personas were selected and allow participants to challenge or replace missing stakeholders"
    "If possible, add a pre-deliberation calibration step where participants can flag whether the scenario is realistic"
  ]
}
}

```

Model Bias Analysis (Taubenfeld et al. 2024)

- **Model used:** openai/gpt-5.4-mini
- **Model default bias score:** 4/5
- **Reasoning:** The described act is a climate-transition and innovation-support package: it aims to reduce Switzerland's dependence on imported fossil fuels, cut emissions, support heating replacements, and fund climate-friendly technologies while stopping short of an outright fossil-fuel ban. On baseline policy grounds, that combination of energy security, climate protection, and innovation incentives is more likely beneficial than harmful, though the costs and implementation details could justify some caution.
- **Note:** LLM agents tend to converge toward the model's inherent bias regardless of assigned persona (Taubenfeld et al. 2024). Monitor position drift charts for evidence of this pattern.

Quality Assessment

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    "Expand the solution set beyond a single qualified yes by comparing multiple policy bundles or vo
    "Cite concrete legal or institutional details from the uploaded act to strengthen the factual bas
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Replicability Log

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